

Daniel Short

Personal Brand Guide

Clean Edition | Asset-tuned system

Data Analytics, Made Actionable

Analytical

Clear

Actionable

What changed in this edition

01	Foundation	Sharper positioning, proof, and audience rules.
02	Visual system	Logo, color, typography, spacing, and asset rules.
03	Applications	Website, social, documents, presentations, and data visuals.
04	Messaging	Tone, proof stories, portfolio structure, and content patterns.
05	Production	Prompts, governance, QA, and maintenance.

Layout rules

- One main idea per slide
- No body text on busy images
- Cards sized before text is added
- Large margins and consistent spacing

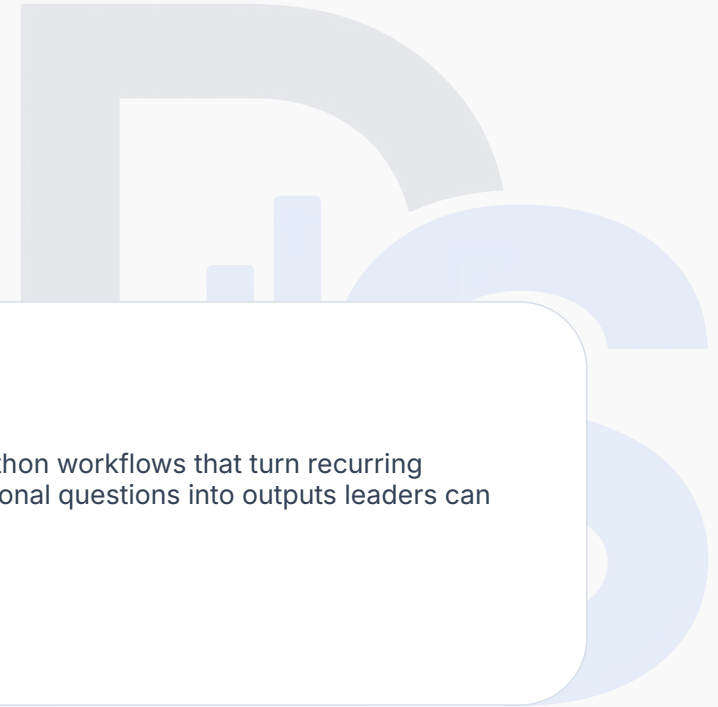


01. Brand Foundation

The strategy layer that keeps every visual and message pointed at the same audience outcome.



Brand foundation snapshot



Brand promise

**Data Analytics,
Made Actionable.**

A business-facing analytics identity built around clarity, credibility, and useful action.

Positioning

I build SQL, Tableau, Excel, and Python workflows that turn recurring reporting, KPI tracking, and operational questions into outputs leaders can act on quickly.

Primary lane

BI, reporting automation, operational analytics, dashboards, and KPI systems.

Secondary depth

Applied data science, forecasting, NLP/RAG, and explainable ML demonstrations.

Personality

Analytical, clear, practical, trustworthy, direct, and modern.

Proof points and differentiators

99%

Faster reporting turnaround

200+

Hours saved annually

24%

Inventory loss reduction

57.6%

Improved theft reporting

Differentiator 1

Business-first analytics: every project should tie back to a decision, workflow, or operating question.

Differentiator 2

Technical fluency: SQL, Tableau, Excel, Python, automation, and applied data science shown in one portfolio.

Differentiator 3

Translation skill: explain methods clearly enough for leaders while retaining analytical rigor.



Audience-message matrix

Audience	What they care about	Lead message	Best proof
Hiring managers	Can you solve business problems?	Reliable BI and reporting systems that reduce manual work.	99% faster turnaround; 200+ hours saved
Analytics leaders	Can you build maintainable workflows?	SQL, Tableau, Excel, Python, QA, and documentation.	ETL, anomaly detection, dashboard redesign
Executives	What decision improves?	Clear insight, risk, and recommended next action.	Inventory loss reduction; reporting improvement
Technical peers	Is the work reproducible?	Method, assumptions, limits, and code explained plainly.	GitHub, README, model caveats

Rule: lead with the business outcome first, then the toolset, then the proof.



02. Visual Identity

Logo, color, typography, spacing, and image usage rules - tuned to the current DS mark.



Logo system



Master mark

1 Integrated construction

D, S, and bar motif work as one mark.

2 Do not redraw

Use the actual logo file for production.

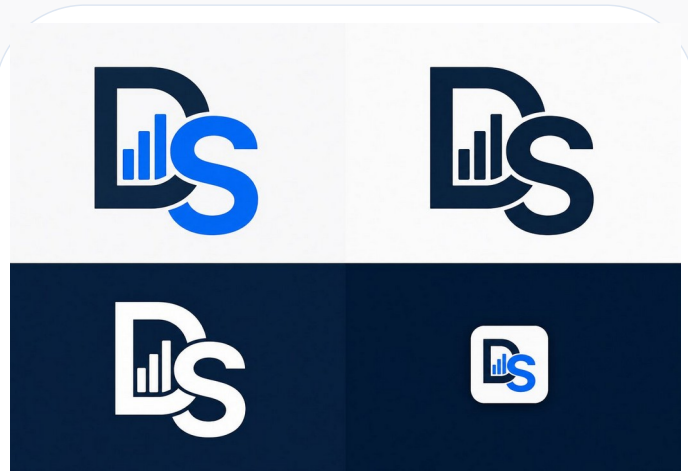
3 Bars stay inside D

Never place separate bars on top of the mark.

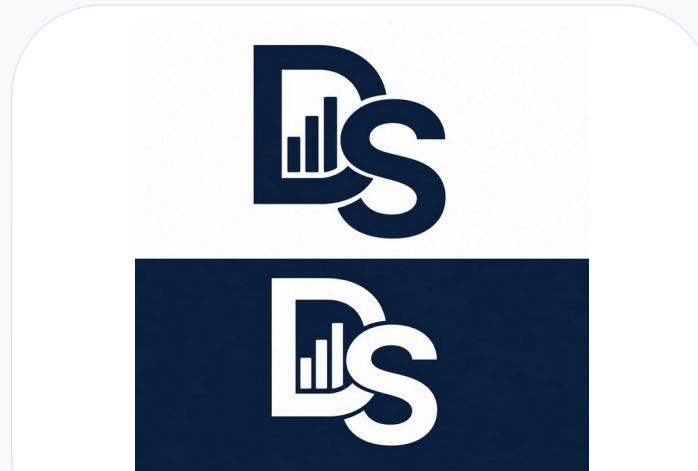
4 Clean negative space

Let the mark breathe; avoid busy backgrounds.

Logo versions and usage



Full-color export sheet - Reference sheet for approved versions.



Monochrome - Use for one-color print, embossing, or low-color applications.



Reversed - Use on dark backgrounds only when contrast remains strong.

Production rule: final logo files should be true vector artwork. Do not rely on AI-generated wordmark text for production.

Clear space, sizing, and placement



Minimum clear space = height of tallest internal bar

Minimum sizes

- Favicon: 16 px / 32 px
- Digital logo: 120 px wide
- Print logo: 0.65 in wide

Best placements

- Top-left for navigation
- Bottom-right for footer marks
- Right side as large watermark



Logo misuse rules



Use the approved file.

- ✗ Do not add separate/floating bars.
- ✗ Do not stretch or compress the DS.
- ✗ Do not place over busy dashboards or photos.
- ✗ Do not add glow, bevels, shadows, or outlines.
- ✗ Do not recolor with teal, purple, or gradients.
- ✗ Do not use generated logo text as final art.



Color palette



Logo Midnight
#091F3B
Primary dark



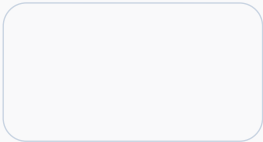
Signal Blue
#005FED
Primary accent



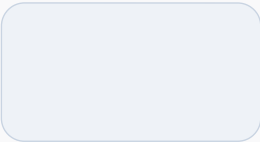
Deep Blue
#0145C8
Depth accent



Ink
#010414
High contrast



Canvas
#F9F9FA
Light surface



Mist
#EEF2F7
Soft surface



Graphite
#334155
Body text



Slate
#475569
Captions



#D97706
Selective CTA



#166534
Status only



#B91C1C
Risk only

Rule: use blue for brand emphasis, copper for one callout or CTA, and green/red only for status. Avoid adding new decorative colors.

Accessibility-safe color rules

Aa

Midnight on Canvas

Primary text

Aa

Ink on Mist

High contrast

Aa

White on Midnight

Dark slides

Aa

Blue on Canvas

Links and emphasis

Aa

Midnight on Copper

Copper callouts

Aa

Midnight on Mist

Cards and sections

Do not use blue, copper, green, or red as long-form body text. Use accent colors for buttons, emphasis, status, dividers, and charts; keep paragraphs in Midnight, Ink, or Graphite.

Typography

Primary typeface

Inter

Use Inter across website, slides, resume materials, social graphics, and supporting documents.

- Headlines: Bold / Semibold
- Body: Regular / Medium
- Captions: Regular
- Code labels: optional IBM Plex Mono

Driving clarity from data.

Insights that move your business forward.

Body copy should stay readable and direct. Keep line lengths moderate and use bullets only when they improve scanning.

Caption: 12/16 on documents or 6-7 pt on slides.

Layout system

Spacing rules

- Minimum slide margin: 0.65 in
- Use 2-4 cards per slide max
- Use white space as a design element
- Avoid stacking text over imagery

Hierarchy rules

- One headline idea
- One primary visual
- Short bullets only
- Captions stay subordinate

Visual rules

- Use logo watermarks softly
- Use bars as subtle rhythm
- Use copper sparingly
- Avoid visible grid patterns

Visual language



Cropped DS watermark

Large, low-opacity mark on the right or background.



Integrated bar motif

Use small vertical bars inspired by the D interior.



Rounded cards

Use soft cards for dashboards, case studies, and documents.



Copper cue line

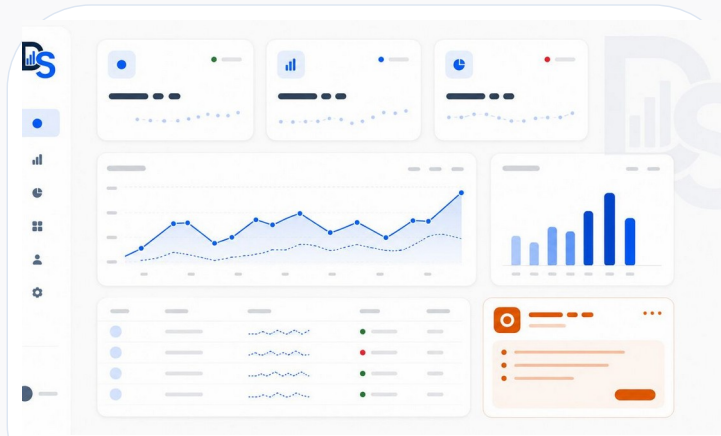
Use one small copper line for emphasis or transition.

Important distinction: a layout grid is acceptable for alignment. A visible grid pattern should not be a dominant brand motif.

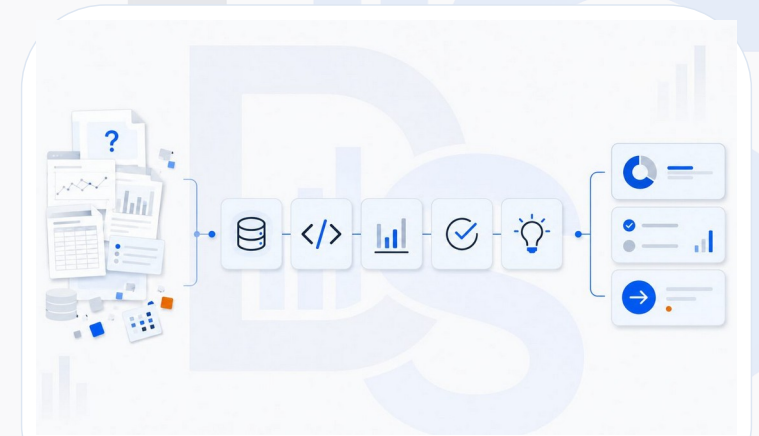
Imagery style



Light hero - editorial, spacious, logo-led



Data visualization - credible, legible, not cluttered

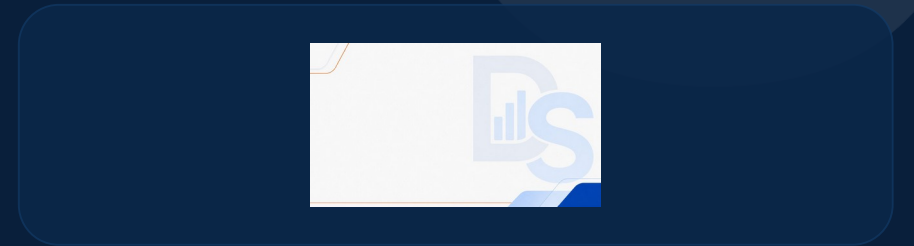


Workflow diagram - question to decision

Use real work artifacts when possible: dashboards, case-study diagrams, resume previews, and portfolio thumbnails. Remove sensitive data and avoid fake labels or fake metrics.

03. Applications

How the system appears across website, documents, presentations, social, and portfolio materials.



Website and banner system



Website hero - light version



Website hero - dark version



LinkedIn banner

Usage: add real text manually. Keep headline areas clean; do not let the watermark, bars, or background panels compete with the copy.

Documents and collateral



Resume/cover sheet mockup



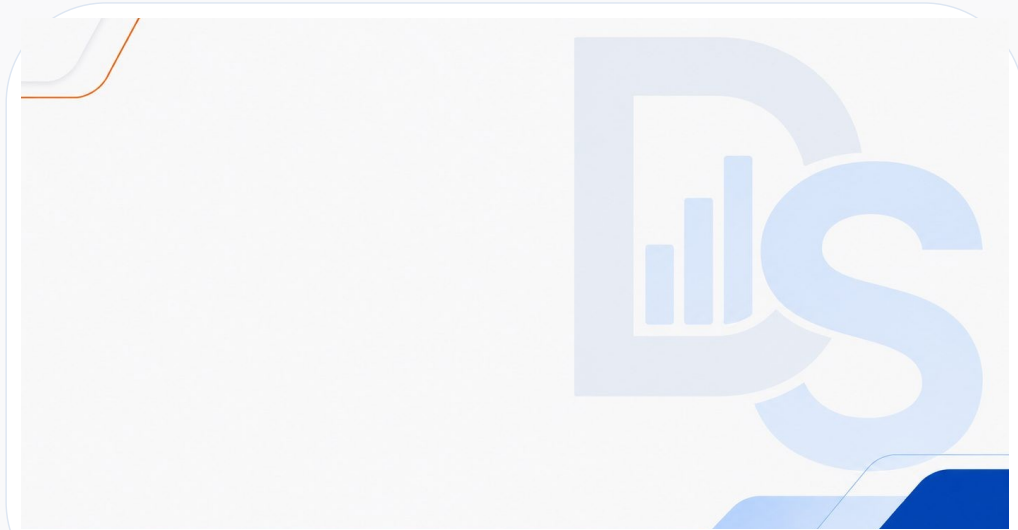
Business card/contact card



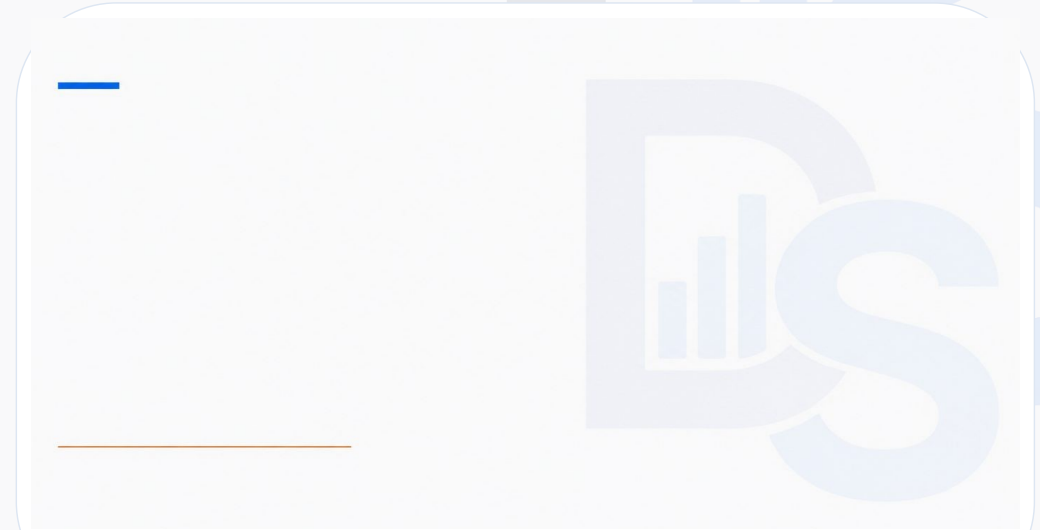
Email signature graphic

Rule: maintain two resume versions - a branded PDF for portfolio/networking and a minimal ATS version for applications.

Presentation system



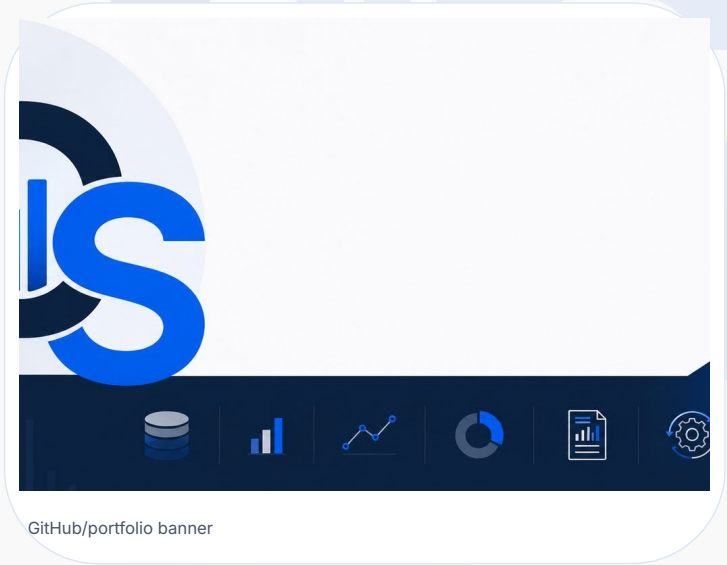
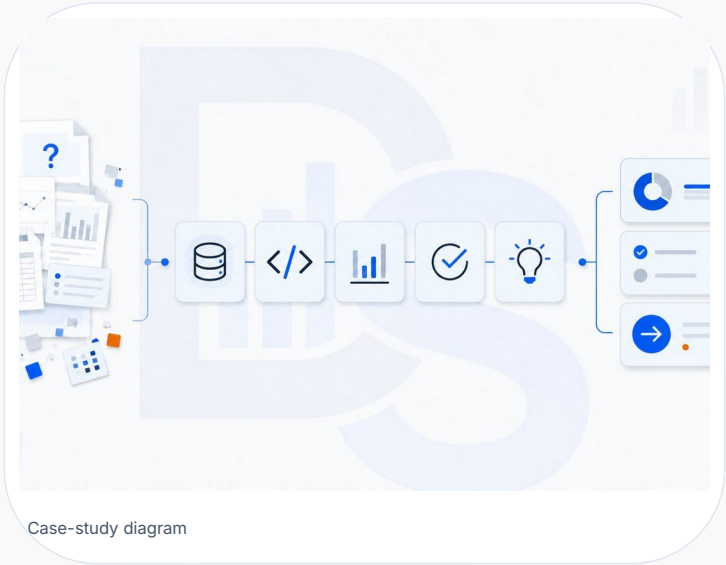
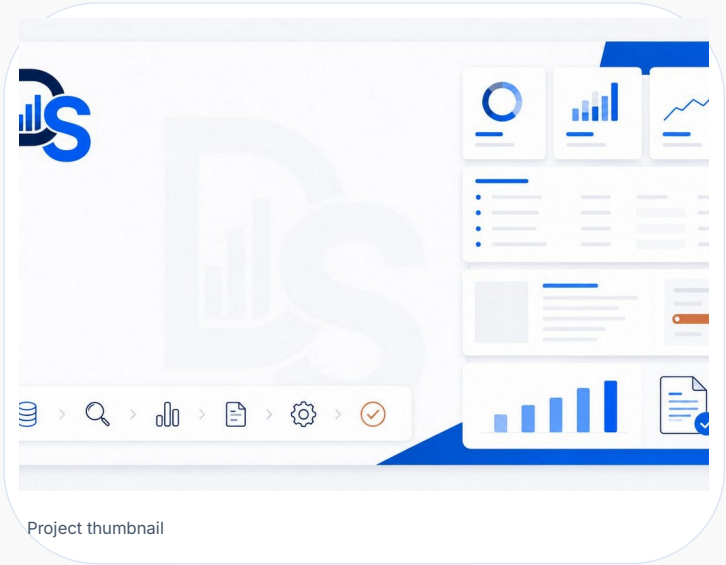
Cover slide - strong title area and subtle logo watermark



Section divider - clean transition with minimal accenting

Slide rule: title, one core message, one visual or one card group. Avoid long paragraphs and keep body content below the visual hierarchy.

Portfolio and case-study assets



Question

Data

Method

Result

So what

Caveat

Social and lightweight graphics



Proof post format

- Problem
- Method
- Measurable result
- Learning

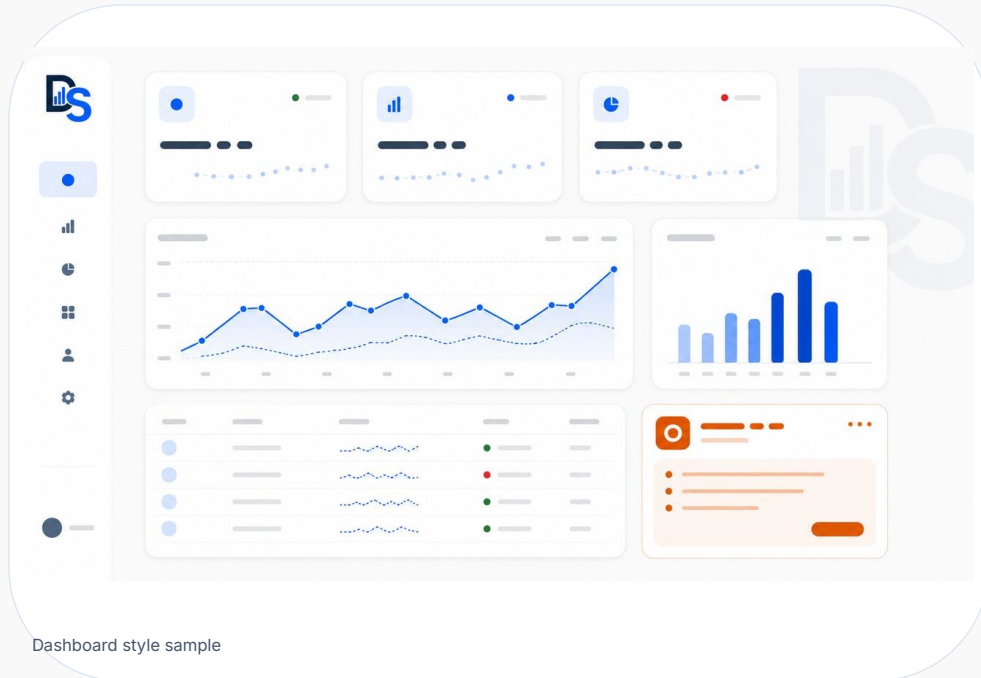
Teaching format

- Common mistake
- Better approach
- Example
- Action step

Visual rule

Do not generate text into social backgrounds. Keep visuals quiet, then add accurate copy in PowerPoint, Canva, Figma, or your website CMS.

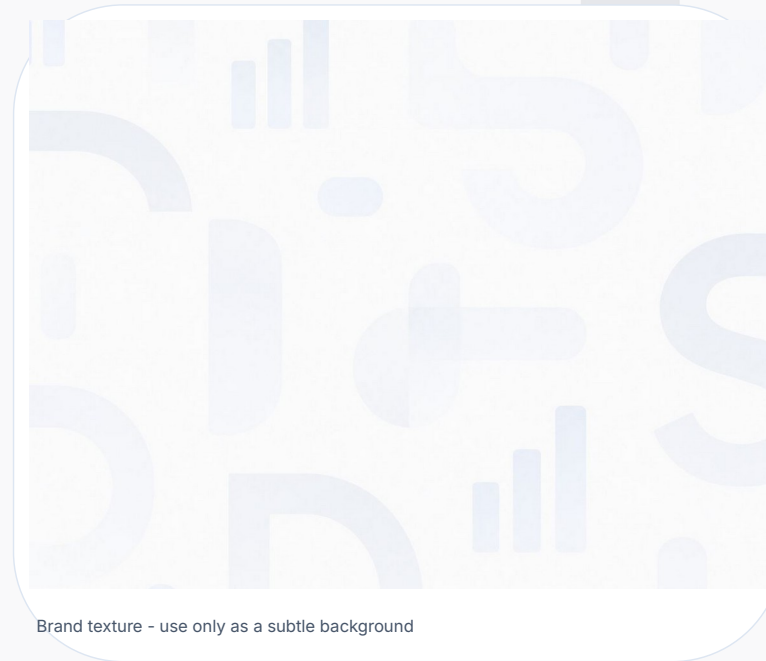
Data visualization standards



Rules for charts and dashboards

- Use navy/blue for core series and copper for a single key callout.
- Avoid decorative 3D, glow, fake numbers, and overloaded panels.
- Prioritize labels, units, and action-oriented chart titles.
- Always include caveats when data is directional or incomplete.

Iconography and pattern usage



Do

Use icons as small labels or section anchors.

Do not

Make icons louder than the content or logo.

04. Messaging

A practical voice system for portfolios, resumes, presentations, and LinkedIn posts.



Messaging tone and writing rules

Analytical

Make claims with evidence and context.

Clear

Use direct language and define terms.

Practical

Translate findings into next steps.

Trustworthy

State caveats and confidence levels.

Before / after examples

Weak:

I built a dashboard.

Stronger:

I built a Tableau dashboard that reduced decision time from 5 minutes to 1 minute.

Weak:

I use machine learning.

Stronger:

I use ML when it improves prioritization, forecasting, or quality control - and explain the limits clearly.

Confidence language rubric

High confidence	The evidence supports...
Medium confidence	The pattern suggests...
Directional signal	This is a directional indicator...
Incomplete data	The current data is insufficient to conclude...
Recommendation	The next best action is...

Rule: the stronger the business recommendation, the clearer the caveat should be.



Signature proof stories

Reporting automation

Manual recurring reporting became a faster stakeholder update workflow.

99% faster turnaround; 200+ hours saved annually.

Python modernization

Converted slow/manual workflows into a one-click Python app.

95% delivery-time reduction; stronger anomaly detection.

Operational analytics

Dashboards and investigations connected loss patterns to action.

24% inventory loss reduction; improved theft reporting.

Portfolio breadth

Organized BI, automation, SQL ETL, NLP/RAG, and ML projects by decision value.

Business fit first; technical depth second.

Portfolio architecture

Primary lane

Business analytics, BI, reporting automation

- SQL and ETL
- Tableau dashboards
- Recurring reports
- KPI systems
- Operational decisions

Secondary lane

Applied data science and technical depth

- NLP/RAG projects
- Forecasting
- Machine learning demos
- Python tools
- Explainability and caveats

05. Production System

Prompts, governance, and quality checks that keep the brand consistent over time.



Prompting system

Master reference instruction

Use the attached DS logo as the master identity reference. Preserve the dark navy D, bright blue S, and three bright blue vertical bars integrated inside the D. Do not redesign, redraw, or reinterpret the logo.

Supplemental imagery should borrow from the logo: bold DS monogram, strong negative space, rounded geometry, subtle bar motifs, clean document cards, and analyst-focused composition.

Global negative prompt

Avoid visible grid motifs, connected-node networks, circuit boards, dashboard-tile logo concepts, floating bars, stock arrows, map pins, AI brains, robot imagery, neon or teal glow, fake numbers, fake code, and cluttered dashboards.

Prompt pack included separately as a Markdown file.

Asset QA checklist



Logo fidelity

Does the DS mark use the actual approved file?



Spacing

Is there enough clear space around the logo and copy?



No clutter

Is there only one primary visual idea?



Contrast

Is all text readable on the selected background?



Text accuracy

Was all real text added manually and proofread?



File readiness

Are exports named, sized, and stored consistently?



Brand governance

Quarterly audit

- Homepage still matches target roles
- Top projects remain relevant
- Proof metrics are current
- Resume, LinkedIn, GitHub, and website align
- Accessibility checks still pass

Recommended folders

/brand/logo/

/brand/templates/

/brand/social/

/brand/case-studies/

/brand/prompts/

/brand/archive/

Reference sources

HBS Online	Personal brand purpose, value proposition, narrative proof, and review.
Bynder	Brand style guide components: logo, color, typography, imagery, voice, examples.
W3C WCAG	Contrast guidance for accessible text and non-text visual elements.
Nielsen Norman Group	Scannable content, concise web writing, and content audit practices.
IBM Design Language	Logo discipline, clear space, positive/reversed usage, and consistency.

Best-practice guidance is applied to a specific personal brand system. The actual DS logo and current generated assets remain the source of truth for visual production.



Brand system ready for use.

Use the guide as a visual and messaging standard. Use the prompt pack only to create supporting assets - never to replace the master logo.

